



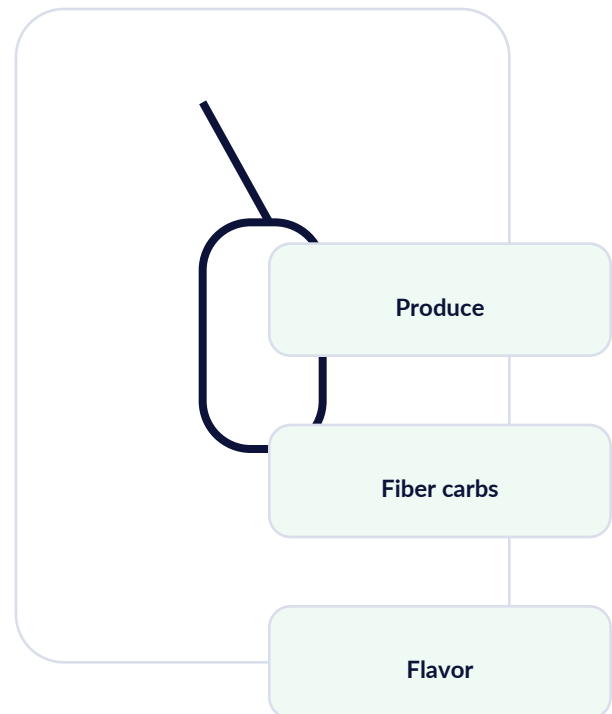
MINDFUL DIABETES FREE GUIDES

Simple, practical guidance for metabolic and brain health.

The Grocery Store Survival Guide

How to Make Practical, Blood Sugar-Conscious Choices Without Feeling Overwhelmed

FREE GUIDE



Mindful Diabetes Inc. | 501(c)(3) nonprofit

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BEFORE SHOPPING

Before you shop

A good grocery trip starts before the store. Check what you already have, choose two or three meals, and pick backup foods for busy days.

- You do not need a perfect list.
- A short list you use is better than an ideal list left at home.



Vegetables

fresh, frozen, canned



Protein

animal or plant



Fiber carbs

oats, beans, grains,
fruit



Healthy fats

nuts, seeds, oils



Flavor

spices, salsa, herbs



FIVE-PART CART

The five-part cart formula



Vegetables

fresh, frozen, canned



Protein

animal or plant



Fiber carbs

oats, beans, grains, fruit



Healthy fats

nuts, seeds, oils



Flavor

spices, salsa, herbs

Build around vegetables, protein, fiber-rich carbohydrates, healthy fats, and flavor builders. This keeps shopping practical without depending on one brand or diet plan.

- Fresh, frozen, canned, and dried foods can all fit.
- Perimeter-only shopping misses many useful budget foods.



PRODUCE

Produce

Choose vegetables and fruits you will actually eat. Fresh produce is wonderful, but it is not the only way to eat well.

Do not rank by aisle

- Fresh can be great
- Frozen can reduce waste
- Canned can save dinner

Check what matters

- Added sugar
- Sodium
- Sauces and serving size

- Pre-cut vegetables can save energy.
- Frozen vegetables may reduce waste.



FROZEN FOODS

Frozen foods



Frozen greens

soups, eggs, bowls



Berries

yogurt or oats



Mixed vegetables

fast side



Frozen fish

protein backup

Frozen vegetables and fruit can be affordable, quick, and nutritious. Look for options without heavy sauces or added sugars when possible.

- Frozen berries work in yogurt or oats.
- Frozen greens can disappear into soups and eggs.



CANNED FOODS

Canned foods

Canned beans, tuna, salmon, vegetables, tomato products, and soups can help on low-energy days. Rinsing canned beans or vegetables can lower sodium.



Beans

rinse to lower sodium



Tomatoes

soups and sauces



Tuna/salmon

shelf-stable protein



Oats

fiber-rich staple

- Compare labels when you can.
- Keep emergency meals in the pantry.



PROTEIN

Protein choices

Protein can come from eggs, fish, poultry, lean meat, tofu, tempeh, yogurt, cottage cheese, beans, lentils, nuts, and seeds.

- Beans and lentils also contain carbohydrate.
- Choose based on budget, culture, and medical needs.



Animal proteins

eggs, fish, poultry, lean meats



Plant proteins

tofu, tempeh, beans, lentils



Dairy

plain yogurt, cottage cheese



Budget options

eggs, canned fish, beans, lentils



PLANT PROTEINS

Beans, lentils, tofu, and plant proteins

Beans, lentils, tofu, tempeh, and edamame can support filling meals. They are useful in soups, tacos, bowls, stir-fries, curries, and salads.



Beans

tacos, soups, bowls



Lentils

dal, soup, salad



Tofu

stir-fries and bowls



Edamame

snacks and sides

- Seasoning matters.
- Start with canned beans if dried beans feel like too much.



GRAINS

Breads, grains, cereals, and tortillas

Front claim	Better check	Why
Multigrain	Ingredient list	May not be whole grain
Whole grain	Fiber + carbs	Compare similar breads
Keto	Sat fat + fiber	Claim is not enough

Look for grains and breads that bring fiber and fit your glucose plan. Whole grain, serving size, and total carbohydrate are more useful than marketing claims alone.

- Multigrain does not always mean whole grain.
- Compare fiber and total carbohydrate.



DAIRY

Dairy and alternatives

Milk and yogurt contain carbohydrate. Plain yogurt, unsweetened fortified soy milk, and lower-sugar options may fit many plans, but allergies and preferences vary.



Plain yogurt

check added sugar



Milk

contains carbohydrate



Soy milk

look for unsweetened fortified



Cheese

check saturated fat

- Check added sugar.
- Choose what fits your taste and budget.



SNACKS

Snacks

A snack can be planned or it can become accidental grazing. Pair protein or fat with fiber when you want something that lasts longer.

- Fruit with nuts.
- Hummus with vegetables.
- Yogurt with berries.



Fiber

fruit, vegetables,
whole grains



Protein/fat

nuts, yogurt,
hummus, egg



Drink

water or unsweet tea



Plan

portion before
hunger spikes



DRINKS

Drinks

Sweet drinks can add sugar quickly. Start by improving one drink you have often rather than overhauling every beverage.

Choose less often

- Large soda, sweet tea, energy drinks
- Juice as a frequent drink
- Sweet coffee additions

Choose more often

- Water or sparkling water
- Unsweet tea or coffee
- Smaller sweet drink as a step-down

- Water, unsweet tea, sparkling water, or smaller sweet drinks can all be steps.
- Alcohol needs medication and safety awareness.



LABEL

Reading the Nutrition Facts label

Label area	Why it matters	Helpful check
Serving size	Numbers are based on this	Compare to your portion
Total carbohydrate	Glucose planning	Check grams
Added sugar	Food quality clue	Lower is often easier
Saturated fat	Heart-health context	Compare similar foods
Sodium	Blood pressure context	5% low, 20% high

Start with serving size, then check total carbohydrate, fiber, added sugar, saturated fat, and sodium. Percent Daily Value helps compare nutrients. [3]

- 5% DV is low and 20% DV is high.
- Serving size is not a personal portion prescription.



CARBS AND SUGAR

Total carbohydrate and added sugar

Total carbohydrate includes starches, fiber, sugars, and added sugars. Added sugars are added during processing or packaging, while naturally occurring sugars can be found in fruit and milk. [4]

- Total carbohydrate matters for glucose.
- Ingredient names do not replace checking total carbohydrate.

Ingredient words	Still check	Reason
Syrup, dextrose, sucrose	Total carbs	Names do not tell portion
Honey, agave, molasses	Added sugar	Still added sugar
Juice concentrate	Serving size	Can add up quickly



FIBER

Fiber

Add one vegetable

Add beans or lentils

Choose oats or whole grains

Add berries, nuts, or seeds

Drink fluids and notice comfort

Fiber can support fullness and steadier meals. The Nutrition Facts label lists dietary fiber in grams and Percent Daily Value.

- Compare similar products.
- Increase fiber gradually.



SODIUM

Sodium

Product	Sodium %DV	Note
Soup A	8%	lower option
Soup B	24%	higher option
Sauce A	5%	low per serving
Sauce B	20%	high per serving

The FDA Daily Value for sodium is less than 2,300 mg per day. Many packaged foods vary widely, so comparing labels can help. [5]

- 5% DV or less is low.
- 20% DV or more is high.



CLAIMS

Ingredient lists and marketing claims

Front labels can be useful, but they are not the whole story. Natural, keto, diabetic-friendly, low-fat, sugar-free, and no sugar added still deserve a label check.



No sugar added

still check total carbs



Sugar-free

not always carb-free



Natural

not a health guarantee



Multigrain

not always whole grain



Keto

still check saturated fat



Low-fat

check sugar and carbs

- Net carbs are not regulated the same way on every label.
- Sugar-free does not always mean carbohydrate-free.



BUDGET

Budget strategies

Use store brands, frozen vegetables, canned beans, oats, eggs, lentils, rice, seasonal produce, and planned leftovers.



Store brand

compare value



Unit price

check shelf label



Freezer

reduce waste



Pantry

backup meals

- Shop your kitchen first.
- Let budget be part of the plan, not a source of shame.



FAST MEALS

Ten-minute meal formulas

Base	Protein	Vegetable	Flavor
Tortilla	beans	cabbage	salsa
Rice	tofu	frozen stir-fry mix	ginger sauce
Crackers	tuna	cucumber	mustard/lemon

Fast meals can still have structure: heat a base, add protein, add vegetables, add flavor, and choose a drink.

- Beans, salsa, greens, and tortillas.
- Frozen vegetables, tofu, sauce, and rice.
- Tuna, crackers, cucumber, fruit, and water.



CHECKLIST

Printable grocery checklist

Use this list as a starting point. Add what fits your family, budget, culture, and medical needs.

Produce

Protein

Fiber-rich carbohydrates

Healthy fats

Drinks

Snacks

Pantry/freezer backups

Notes



NEXT STEPS

Make the store easier next time

Save one list that worked, one backup meal, and one label comparison. The next trip gets easier when you do not start from scratch.

- Download another free guide.
- Visit Health Tools.
- Share this guide with a caregiver or friend.

Explore the Guide

Visit Health Tools

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Support free education

Medical disclaimer

This guide is general education, not medical advice. Individual needs vary. Do not change medication, insulin, or glucose targets based on this guide.



REFERENCES AND SAFETY

References and medical disclaimer

Medical disclaimer

This guide is for general education only. It is not medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Individual needs vary. Do not change medication, insulin, or glucose targets based on this guide. Seek appropriate medical attention for severe low blood sugar, severe high blood sugar, sudden confusion, chest pain, trouble breathing, fainting, seizures, or other urgent symptoms.

References

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